

Lab No 4:

Date:

Introduction and Point to Point Communications in MPI

Objectives:

In this lab, student will be able to

1. Understand the execution environment of MPI programs
2. Learn and use the Basics API available in MPI
3. Understand the different APIs used for point to point communication in MPI
4. Learn the different modes available in case of blocking send operation

I. Introduction

In order to reduce the execution time work is carried out in parallel. Two types of parallel programming are:

- Explicit parallel programming
- Implicit parallel programming

Explicit parallel programming – These are languages where the user has full control and has to explicitly provide all the details. Compiler effort is minimal.

Implicit parallel programming – These are sequential languages where the compiler has full responsibility for extracting the parallelism in the program.

Parallel Programming Models:

- Message Passing Programming
- Shared Memory Programming

Message Passing Programming:

- In message passing programming, programmers view their programs (Applications) as a collection of co-operating processes with private (local) variables.
- The only way for an application to share data among processors is for programmer to explicitly code commands to move data from one processor to another.

Message Passing Libraries: There are two message passing libraries available. They are:

- PVM – Parallel Virtual Machine

- MPI – Message Passing Interface. It is a set of parallel APIs which can be used with languages such as C and FORTRAN.

Communicators and Groups:

- MPI assumes static processes.
- All the processes are created when the program is loaded.
- No process can be created or terminated in the middle of program execution.
- There is a default process group consisting of all such processes identified by

MPI_COMM_WORLD.

III. MPI Environment Management Routines:

MPI_Init: Initializes the MPI execution environment. This function must be called in every MPI program, must be called before any other MPI functions and must be called only once in an MPI program.

```
MPI_Init (&argc,&argv);
```

MPI_Comm_size: Returns the total number of MPI processes to the variable size in the specified communicator, such as MPI_COMM_WORLD.

```
MPI_Comm_size(Comm,&size);
```

MPI_Comm_rank: Returns the rank of the calling MPI process within the specified communicator. Each process will be assigned a unique integer rank between 0 and size - 1 within the communicator MPI_COMM_WORLD. This rank is often referred to as a process ID.

```
MPI_Comm_rank Comm,&rank);
```

MPI_Finalize: Terminates the MPI execution environment. This function should be the last MPI routine called in every MPI program. No other MPI routines may be called after it.

```
MPI_Finalize ();
```

Solved Example:

Implement a program in MPI to print total number of process and rank of each process.

```

#include "mpi.h"
#include <stdio.h>
int main(int argc, char *argv[])
{
    int rank, size;

    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);
    MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &rank);
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &size);
    printf("My rank is %d in total %d processes", rank, size);
    MPI_Finalize();
    return 0;
}

```

Steps to execute a MPI program is provided in the form of video which is available in individual systems. However, the basic installation steps are given as follows.

// Follow the following steps to Install, Compile and Run MPI programs in Ubuntu O.S

// To install MPI in Ubuntu, execute the following command in command line

\$sudo apt-get update; sudo apt-get install mpich

// To edit MPI program, use any text editor such as vim or gedit and create a file with .c extension.

//To Compile MPI program, execute the following command in command line

\$mpicc filename.c -o filename.out

//To Run MPI program, execute the following command in command line

\$mpirun -np 4 filename.out

Point to Point communication in MPI

- MPI point-to-point operations typically involve message passing between two, and only two, different MPI tasks. One task is performing a send operation and the other task is performing a matching receive operation.
- MPI provides both blocking and non-blocking send and receive operations.

Sending message in MPI

- **Blocked Send** sends a message to another processor and waits until the receiver has received it before continuing the process. Also called as **Synchronous send**.

- Send sends a message and continues without waiting. Also called as Asynchronous send.

There are multiple communication modes used in blocking send operation:

- **Standard mode**
- **Synchronous mode**
- **Buffered mode**

Standard mode

This mode blocks until the message is buffered.

```
MPI_Send(&Msg, Count, Datatype, Destination, Tag, Comm);
```

- First 3 parameters together constitute message buffer. The **Msg** could be any address in sender's address space. The **Count** indicates the number of data elements of a particular type to be sent. The **Datatype** specifies the message type. Some Data types available in MPI are: MPI_INT, MPI_FLOAT, MPI_CHAR, MPI_DOUBLE, MPI_LONG
- Next 3 parameters specify message envelope. The **Destination** specifies the rank of the process to which the message is to be sent.
- **Tag**: The **tag** is an integer used by the programmer to label different types of messages and to restrict message reception.
- **Communicator**: Major problem with tags is that they are specified by users who can make mistakes. **Context** are allocated at run time by the system in response to user request and are used for matching messages. The notions of **context and group** are combined in a single object called a communicator (**Comm**).
- The default process group is **MPI_COMM_WORLD**.

Synchronous mode

This mode requires a send to block until the corresponding receive has occurred.

```
MPI_Ssend(&Msg, Count, Datatype, Destination, Tag, Comm);
```

Solved Example:

Implement a MPI program using standard send. The sender process sends a number to the receiver. The second process receives the number and prints it.


```

#include "mpi.h"
#include <stdio.h>
int main(int argc, char *argv[])
{
    int rank, size, x;
    MPI_Init(&argc, &argv);
    MPI_Comm_rank(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &rank);
    MPI_Comm_size(MPI_COMM_WORLD, &size);
    MPI_Status status;
    if(rank==0)
    {
        Printf("Enter a value in master process:");
        scanf("%d", &x);
        MPI_Send(&x, 1, MPI_INT, 1, 1, MPI_COMM_WORLD);
        fprintf(stdout, "I have sent %d from process 0\n", x);
        fflush(stdout);
    }
    else
    {
        MPI_Recv(&x, 1, MPI_INT, 0, 1, MPI_COMM_WORLD, &status);
        fprintf(stdout, "I have received %d in process 1\n", x);
        fflush(stdout);
    }
    MPI_Finalize();
    return 0;
}

```

Buffered mode

```
MPI_Bsend(&Msg, Count, Datatype, Destination, Tag, Comm);
```

In this mode a send assumes availability of a certain amount of buffer space, which must be previously specified by the user program through a routine call that allocates a user buffer.

```
MPI_Buffer_attach(buffer, size);
```

This buffer can be released by

```
MPI_Buffer_detach(*buffer, *size);
```

Receiving message in MPI

```
MPI_Recv(&Msg, Count, Datatype, Source, Tag, Comm, &status);
```

- Receive a message and block until the requested data is available in the application buffer in the receiving task.
- The Msg could be any address in receiver's address space. The Count specifies number of data items. The Datatype specifies the message type. The Source specifies the rank of the process which has sent the message. The Tag and Comm should be same as that is used in corresponding send operation. The status is a structure of type status which contains following information: Sender's rank, Sender's tag and number of items received

Finding execution time in MPI

MPI Wtime: Returns an elapsed wall clock time in seconds (double precision) on the calling processor.

Lab Exercises:

1. Implement a simple MPI program to find out pow (x, rank) for all the processes where 'x' is the integer constant and 'rank' is the rank of the process.
2. Implement a program in MPI to toggle the character of a given string indexed by the rank of the process. Hint: Suppose the string is HELLO and there are 5 processes, then process 0 toggle 'H' to 'h', process 1 toggle 'E' to 'e' and so on.
3. Implement a program in MPI where even ranked process prints factorial of the rank and odd ranked process prints ranks Fibonacci number.
4. Implement a MPI program using synchronous send. The sender process sends a word to the receiver. The second process receives the word, toggles each letter of the word and sends it back to the first process. Both processes use synchronous send operations.
5. Implement a MPI program where the master process (process 0) sends a number to each of the slaves and the slave processes receive the number and prints it. Use standard send.
6. Implement a MPI program to read an integer value in the root process. Root process sends this value to Process1, Process1 sends this value to Process2 and so on. Last process sends the value back to root process. When sending the value each process will first increment the received value by one. Implement the program using point to point communication routines.
7. Implement a MPI program to read N elements of the array in the root process (process 0) where N is equal to the total number of processes. The root process sends one value to each of the slaves. Let even ranked process finds square of the received element and odd ranked process finds cube of received element. Use Buffered send.

Additional Exercises:

1. Implement a program in MPI to reverse the digits of the following integer array of size 9 with 9 processes. Initialize the array to the following values.
Input array : 18, 523, 301, 1234, 2, 14, 108, 150, 1928
Output array: 81, 325, 103, 4321, 2, 41, 801, 51, 8291
2. Implement a MPI program to read N elements of an array in the master process. Let N processes including master process check the array values are prime or not.